WHO RUNS THE HALLS

A student guide to the cliques of Hutchinson High | Class of 2005

1 JOCKS

Hangout: Gowans Stadium weight room and the Starlite Drive-In

Brock "Tank" Hargrove (senior, quarterback, the principal's son)

Dana Kessler (senior, girls' basketball captain)

Look Tank is built like a grain silo and smiles like a campaign poster. Dana is quiet, fast and keeps the weight room schedule.

Rules by Friday night results and who shows up to practice. Tank leads with swagger, Dana leads by running the extra mile first.

Wants A state title and a scholarship for the whole starting lineup.

Earn their trust Show up to a practice or a Friday night game and cheer loud.

Enemy Theater, led by Julian Prescott and Opal Vance.

The whisper *People say Tank stopped sleeping this fall and runs the stadium steps long after dark.*

2 BAND

Hangout: the band room and the halftime field

Lindsey Voss (senior, head drum major)

Terrence "T-Bone" Mabry (senior, trombone section leader)

Look Lindsey wears her whistle like a badge of office. T-Bone keeps the section laughing and the instruments clean.

Rules by Rehearsals that run on the clock and a halftime show nobody forgets. The band stays loyal to anyone who carries a case.

Wants A standing ovation at the state marching festival.

Earn their trust Carry a case at rehearsal and stay for the whole run.

Enemy Student Council, led by Allison Whitcomb and Darnell Greer.

The whisper *Some say the band plays one tune at halftime that nobody remembers learning.*

3 AG / FFA

Hangout: the livestock barns at the fairgrounds

Colt Brandvold (senior, FFA chapter president)

Maribel Sandoval (senior, 4-H livestock champion)

Look Colt wears the blue corduroy jacket every day and tips his cap to teachers. Maribel never loses a handshake contest.

Rules by Chores come first, then favors. Colt calls in help the way his family calls in a harvest crew.

Wants A good wheat year and a scholarship to K-State.

Earn their trust Join the chores at dawn and do not complain about the smell.

Enemy Robotics, led by Wendell Ng and Fiona Kowalczyk.

The whisper *The old farmers say the wheat north of town is growing in odd rings this year.*

4 THEATER

Hangout: the Fox Theatre, the auditorium and the Starlite Drive-In

Julian Prescott (senior, drama club president)

Opal Vance (senior, stage manager)

Look Julian wears a scarf in September and quotes Shakespeare to teachers. Opal wears black, carries a headset and runs the real show.

Rules by Casting and keys. Julian charms the room, Opal decides who gets backstage.

Wants A lead in a professional production and a standing ovation at the spring play.

Earn their trust Volunteer to strike the set after a show.

Enemy Jocks, led by Brock Hargrove and Dana Kessler.

The whisper *The Fox marquee has spelled some strange messages lately, and the crew will not talk about it.*

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5 BURNOUTS

Hangout: the back lot, the Kwik Shop and the Starlite Drive-In

Ricky "Razor" Dunleavy (senior, the back lot king)

Shelby Marsh (senior, rumor broker)

Look Razor leans on a rusted Chevy with the radio on low. Shelby writes everything down in a spiral notebook she never lets anyone read.

Rules by Information. They know who has what, who owes whom and which adult is lying.

Wants To graduate, if only to prove people wrong.

Earn their trust Keep a secret, or bring a trade worth more than gossip.

Enemy Valedictorians and Hall Monitors, led by Ellie Park, Nathaniel Brandt and Gordon Pruitt.

The whisper *Shelby claims she knows what the Kwik Shop night crew really does at two in the morning.*

6 ROBOTICS

Hangout: the Cosmosphere lab and the Salt Flats Radio Tower

Wendell Ng (senior, club president)

Fiona Kowalczyk (senior, lead programmer)

Look Wendell wears a lanyard of keys and talks in diagrams. Fiona answers questions with code and a very dry look.

Rules by Competence. A rover that works beats a speech that does not.

Wants A national robotics title and an internship at the Cosmosphere.

Earn their trust Bring a working part or a very good question.

Enemy Ag / FFA, led by Colt Brandvold and Maribel Sandoval.

The whisper *Fiona's club has been staying late with the dish pointed at town.*

7 STUDENT COUNCIL

Hangout: the main office, the courthouse and the Governors Row circuit

Allison Whitcomb (senior, council president)

Darnell Greer (senior, vice president)

Look Allison has a campaign smile and the school keys. Darnell has the spreadsheets and a patient way of making a no sound like a maybe.

Rules by Budgets, passes and announcements. Nothing happens at Hutchinson High without a signature.

Wants To be class valedictorian and a congressional page.

Earn their trust Volunteer for a committee and finish what you start.

Enemy Band, led by Lindsey Voss and T-Bone Mabry.

The whisper *The council's books supposedly have a line nobody can explain.*

8 GOTHS

Hangout: the Underground Library and Fairlawn Burial Park

Morgan "Mourn" Teague (senior, keeper of the Underground Library)

Silas Hartwell (senior, poet and club treasurer)

Look Morgan wears a long black coat in July and speaks softly enough that you lean in. Silas writes verses on his hands in ballpoint pen.

Rules by Stories and obscure knowledge. Trade a rumor and you can borrow a book.

Wants To publish a zine that outlives the school.

Earn their trust Trade a rumor for a rumor.

Enemy Popular Kids, led by Kayleigh Dunbar and Chase Whitaker.

The whisper *The Underground Library is said to hold a book that is never finished.*

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9 POPULAR KIDS

Hangout: the country club pool, Carey Park, the Starlite Drive-In

Kayleigh Dunbar (senior, homecoming queen)

Chase Whitaker (senior, class vice president and heir to the grocery family)

Look Kayleigh remembers your name and your secrets. Chase wears his letterman jacket over a collared shirt and never raises his voice.

Rules by Invitations. Everyone knows your name only if Kayleigh says it first.

Wants To be crowned at prom and to leave town on their own terms.

Earn their trust Bring news, a plus one or a ride.

Enemy Goths, led by Morgan Teague and Silas Hartwell.

The whisper *Someone in Kayleigh's circle got a strange offer in the mail.*

10 VALEDICTORIANS

Hangout: the dual credit lab and the courthouse records office

Eleanor "Ellie" Park (senior, class rank 1)

Nathaniel Brandt (senior, class rank 2)

Look Ellie color codes her binders and her enemies. Nathaniel plays the humble rival and keeps a ledger of her mistakes.

Rules by Rank. Teachers trust them first, and students ask them for answers.

Wants A full ride to a top school and a speech worth quoting.

Earn their trust Share good notes and never cut in line.

Enemy Burnouts, led by Razor Dunleavy and Shelby Marsh.

The whisper *Ellie has spent weeks staring at the records office door.*

11 HALL MONITORS

Hangout: the main hall, the detention room, the Westside Water Tower

Gordon "Gordie" Pruitt (senior, head hall monitor)

Wanda Schaeffer (senior, deputy hall monitor)

Look Gordie wears a clip on tie and a laminated badge he made himself. Wanda carries a flashlight and a pad of carbonless forms.

Rules by Reports. A signed incident form can end a rumor or begin a suspension.

Wants A letter of recommendation from Principal Hargrove and a job in law enforcement.

Earn their trust Follow the rules in front of them and sign their log.

Enemy Burnouts and Bullies, led by Razor Dunleavy and Cole Dettmer.

The whisper *Gordie keeps a binder of names he will not show anyone.*

12 BULLIES

Hangout: the east stairwell and the lot behind Gowans Stadium

Cole "Crusher" Dettmer (senior, enforcer, family owns the auto yard)

Tiffany "Tiff" Rourke (senior, cafeteria table ringleader)

Look Cole fills a doorway and never has to raise his voice. Tiff smiles while she collects your lunch money.

Rules by Fear and favors. Pay the toll or find another hallway.

Wants To own the hallways until graduation and never be written up for it.

Earn their trust Pay up, back them up, or hand them someone else.

Enemy Hall Monitors, led by Gordon Pruitt and Wanda Schaeffer.

The whisper *Cole keeps a list of every senior who got a strange offer in the mail, and he has not said why.*